

Revolutions

People all over the world have risen up against oppressive rulers. Revolutions can be sudden or lengthy, bloody or peaceful, but have one thing in common: they are all an attempt to change the way a country is ruled.



Collapse of Communism

The USSR was a Communist state that incorporated Russia and 14 other Soviet republics (some of the red areas on the map). The USSR also had great influence over several other European states that collectively were known as the "Communist bloc" (some of the yellow map areas). In 1989, revolution spread through all these states, and in 1991 the USSR was dissolved.

▼ **Fall of communism**
 Indicates countries in which Communism collapsed in 1989-91



Arab Spring

The "Arab Spring" revolutions and protests swept through the Arab world in 2011. As the map shows, in some countries rulers were forced out, while in others there were failed uprisings. The Arab Spring was the first uprising where protestors used social media

to coordinate their actions. Not all of the movements were successful, however; the uprising in Tunisia led to a number of improvements, but many of the other countries are still marked by unrest.

▲ **Arab Spring**
 Indicates countries involved in the Arab Spring